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Programme at a Glance

9th ZIMAM Digital Health Forum

4 – 6 November 2026 · Jumeirah Emirates Towers, Dubai

DAY 1 · Wednesday 4 November 2026 · Forum Day		
Time	**Room 1**	**Room 2**
08:45 – 10:45	**Official Opening & Plenary Session** *Building the Future of Digital Health: Vision, Partnership and Action*	
11:15 – 17:15	Health AI Summit	Health Information Exchange Summit
17:15 - 17:30	MoU Signing	
18:00 – 20:00	ZIMAM Digital Health Innovation Awards	

DAY 2 · Thursday 5 November 2026 · Post-Forum Workshops		
Time	**Room 1**	**Room 2**
09:00 – 17:00	Workshop: Competency-based Framework for Digital Health Careers	Trusted Data, Connected Care: A Regenstrief Institute Terminology Workshop (Day 1 of 2)

DAY 3 · Friday 6 November 2026 · Post-Forum Workshop	
Time	**Room 2**
09:00 – 17:00	Trusted Data, Connected Care: A Regenstrief Institute Terminology Workshop (Day 2 of 2)

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Official Opening & Plenary Session

Building the Future of Digital Health: Vision, Partnership and Action

4 November 2026 · 08:45 AM – 10:45 AM

Speaker status: Confirmed | Awaiting confirmation or details | Not attending in person | No highlight: not on speaker tracker | Different from last version

Time	Session	Speakers
PLENARY SESSION · 08:45 – 10:45 · Building the Future of Digital Health		
08:45 – 08:55	Opening **Welcome & Opening Remarks**	
08:55 – 09:20	Keynote Address **Responsible Governance in the Age of Agentic AI: Safety, Accountability and Trust in Clinical Practice**	Dr Melanie Tan, Consultant Anaesthetist & Perioperative Physician, University College London Hospitals NHS Trust; Director of Medical Informatics, Cleveland Clinic London, UK
09:20 – 10:00	Executive Panel **Shared Vision, Shared Health: Crafting the Blueprint for the Next Generation of AI-Powered Electronic Medical Records**	**Moderator:** Dr Dari Al-Huwail **Panelists:** Yasir Khan, Clinical Director, Oracle Health and Life Sciences, UAE Baha Sayiner, Head of IT, Medicare, UAE Mr Sandeep Kumar, CIO, King's College Raed Rafeh, Director of Solutions and Applications Delivery, Dubai Health Dr Shadab Khan, Senior Scientist, ADIA Lab, UAE
10:00 – 10:40	Executive Panel **From Health Sandbox to Scale: Who Will Own the Trusted Digital Health Economy?**	**Moderator:** Dr Mazin Gadir **Panelists:** Hamid Al Mahdali, Head of Policy, Sandbox Dubai, DHA Entisar Al-Mutairi, Director, Regulatory Health Sandbox, MoH, KSA (online) Kholoud Al-Ali, Specialist, Data & Health Informatics Department, DHA

Time	Session	Speakers
10:40 – 10:45	Closing ZIMAM 2026 Highlights & Forum Preview (Video)	

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Health Information Exchange Summit 2026

From Data Exchange to Data Utility: Semantic Interoperability for Social Care and Preventive Public Health

4 November 2026 · 11:15 AM – 5:15 PM

Speaker status: Confirmed | Awaiting confirmation or details | Not attending in person | No highlight: not on speaker tracker | Different from last version

Time	Session	Speakers
MORNING SESSION · 11:15 – 13:15 · From Exchange to Utility: Setting the Scene		
11:15 – 11:20	Opening **Welcome Note & Framing: The Perspective of HIEs in the UAE's Digital Health Strategy**	Guest of Honour (TBC)
11:20 – 11:40	UAE Insights · Fireside Chat **UAE HIEs 2026: From Data Exchange to Health Data Utility — Strategy, Milestones and the Semantic Layer**	Speaker (TBC), DHA, UAE Representative, Department of Health Abu Dhabi / Malaffi (TBC)
11:40 – 12:00	GCC Insights · Keynote **HIE and Beyond: HIE Use Cases**	Representative, National Health Information Center (NHIC) / Lean Healthcare, KSA (TBC)
12:00 – 12:20	Vendor Insights · Special Fireside Chat **Boosting HIE Clinical Engagement: Agentic-AI Record Summarisation Advancements**	Dr Tamara Sunbul, CIO, Fakeeh Care Group Vendor X (TBC) Vendor Y (TBC)
12:20 – 12:40	Regional Spotlight · Special Lecture **Health Information Exchange in Qatar: Expanding the Data Perimeter to Include Population Health & Social Care**	Dr Juliet Ibrahim, Director of eHealth, Ministry of Public Health, Qatar
12:40 – 13:00	Learning from the World · Keynote **The Business Case for Standards in Connected Care: Highlights from the OECD Report**	Rachelle Fellner, Consultant, OECD
13:00 – 13:15	Vendor Insights · Special Lecture **Building Connected Healthcare at Scale: Lessons from the Middle East**	Mustafa Almukhtar, Regional Director MEA, Orion Health
13:15 – 14:00	*Lunch Break*	
AFTERNOON SESSION 1 · 14:00 – 15:30 · HIE Maturity & Terminology: The Quality Imperative		

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Time	Session	Speakers
14:00 – 14:15	Vendor Insights **Trust at Scale: Securing Patient Privacy and Compliance in HIE Systems and EHRs**	Anthony Dibble, Principal Solutions Engineer, Imprivata
14:15 – 14:50	Panel 1 · GCC & MENA Discussion Panel **HIE Maturity Models: Where Do We Stand and Where Do We Need to Go?** **Panel description:** *Drawing on the O3C Interoperability Maturity Model and the Civitas Health Data Utility Framework, this panel will map HIEs in the region to a common HIE maturity ladder. Panelists will debate what Level 3 vs Level 5 maturity means in practice, what the most common obstacles to progression are, and what investment and governance decisions are required to reach Health Data Utility status.*	**Moderator:** Rachelle Fellner, Consultant, OECD **Panelists:** Dr Brian Dixon, Associate Professor, Regenstrief Institute, USA Dr Ahmed Balkhair, Board Member, ZIMAM, KSA Jurgen Brandstatter, Member of the Board, IHE, Austria
14:50 – 15:00	Learning from the World · Lecture **Real-World Deployment: Terminology Services for National HIE Platforms**	Joe Amlung, Senior Technical Advisor, Global Health Informatics; Product Owner, Open Concept Lab, USA
15:00 – 15:20	Knowledge Transfer · Special Lecture **Unlocking the Value of HIE Data for Public Health and Population Health Analytics**	Dr Brian Dixon, Associate Professor, Regenstrief Institute, USA
15:20 – 15:30	Vendor Highlights **Transforming Longitudinal Health Records into Research-Grade Data to Deliver Real-World Evidence (RWE)**	Tianze Zhang (Tony), Founder & CEO, LinkDoc Technology
15:30 – 15:45	*Coffee & Networking Breaka*	
AFTERNOON SESSION 2 · 15:45 – 17:15 · Terminology Services & Social Care Data Utility		
15:45 – 16:05	Knowledge Transfer · Fireside Chat **From Interoperability to Operability: HIEs as the Nervous System of National Command Centres**	Adjunct Professor Anita Ghose, Program Lead, AIDH, Australia Charles Aunger, CIO, American Hospital Dubai, UAE Dr Saleh Fares Al-Ali, Consultant of Emergency Medicine, EMS and Disaster Medicine, CEO, HEM360
16:05 – 16:50	Panel 2 · Thematic Discussion Panel **Terminology Services as the Engine of HIE Data Quality: From Validation to Cross-Standard Mapping** **Panel description:** *Without a terminology service governing the codes that flow through an HIE, semantic drift is inevitable — local codes accumulate, LOINC adoption stalls, immunisation records lose their 360° view, and public health reports become unreliable. This panel will explain the upstream/downstream model: upstream services intercept and validate or normalise codes at ingestion, while downstream services map between standard systems to repurpose stored codes for immunisation registries, population health phenotyping and other use cases.*	**Moderator:** Dr Osama Elhassan, Chair, ZIMAM, UAE **Panelists:** Representative, Malaffi / DoH Abu Dhabi Clinical Informatics, UAE (TBC) Jennifer Shivers, Digital Health Specialist, Regenstrief Institute, USA Tarek Kadoura, Director Business Operations, Infoway, Canada GCC / Egypt / Morocco practitioner sharing a regional deployment story (TBC)

Time	Session	Speakers
16:50 – 17:05	Knowledge Transfer · Lecture **The Role of the Standards Release Center**	Tarek Kadoura, Director Business Operations, Infoway, Canada
17:05 – 17:15	Closing **Summit Summary, Key Takeaways and Call to Action: The ZIMAM Semantic Interoperability Declaration 2026**	Dr Ahmed Balkhair, Board Member, ZIMAM, KSA Dr Mohammad Al Redha, DHA, UAE

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Health AI Summit 2026

Intelligence with Accountability: Shaping the Future of Health AI in the MENA Region

4 November 2026 · 11:15 AM – 5:00 PM

Speaker status: Confirmed | Awaiting confirmation or details | Not attending in person | No highlight: not on speaker tracker | Different from last version

Time	Session	Speakers
MORNING SESSION · 11:15 – 13:15 · Governing the Machine: Safety, Accountability and the Clinician		
11:15 – 11:35	Opening Keynote **Welcome and Opening Remarks — The Vision for Accountable Health AI: Lessons Learned from Europe & the US**	Guest of Honour (TBC)
11:35 – 11:55	GCC Insights · Keynote **Intelligent Hospital Roadshow — From Copilot to Orchestrator: Agentic AI in Clinical and Operational Health Systems**	Dr Mubaraka Ibrahim
11:55 – 12:35	Knowledge Transfer · Executive Panel **The Infodemic Comes Home: AI, Misinformation and the Mental Wellbeing of Women & Adolescents**	**Moderator:** Dr Ramy Azzam, Senior Clinical Advisor, Social Prescribing Alliance Network, UAE **Panelists:** Dr Melisa Valle, Senior Research Lead, Global Digital Wellbeing Programme (Sync), King Abdulaziz Centre for World Culture (Ithra), KSA Andy Pattison, Team Lead, Frontier Technologies, WHO, Switzerland Dr Nahida Nayaz Ahmed, Chief Medical Officer, SAKINA, UAE Dr Yacin Hadjiyat, Head of Innovation, Dubai Health, UAE Further panelist (TBC)
12:35 – 12:50	Vendor Insights · Special Lecture **From Decision Support to Intelligent Orchestration: Agentic AI in Clinical and Operational Health Systems**	Romel Khalife, Country Manager – UAE and Kuwait, Oracle Health and Life Sciences

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Time	Session	Speakers
12:50 – 13:15	UAE Insights · Fireside Chat **The Oversight Imperative — Human-in-the-Loop Design to Realise Responsible AI**	**Moderator:c** Dr Ahmad Awada, Innovations and Digital Health Director, Mediclinic Middle East **Speakers:** Donald Lazure, Enterprise Clinical Strategy Lead, Commure Dr Scott Fraser, VP GCC Region, Heidi Health Speaker (TBC), eClinicalWorks
13:15 – 14:00	*Lunch Break*	
AFTERNOON SESSION · 14:00 – 15:30 · Scaling Responsible AI		
14:00 – 14:15	Vendor Insights **Title (TBC)**	Vendor (TBC)
14:15 – 14:55	Discussion Panel **Scaling Responsible AI for Health in Low-Resource Settings** **Panel description:** *The panel explores opportunities and challenges in scaling responsible AI for health in low-resource settings, emphasising equity, governance and sustainability. It also highlights practical strategies to implement private and cost-effective infrastructure to enable open-source LLMs and agentic AI solutions.*	**Moderator:** Dr Nour El Arnout **Panelists:** Dr Shadi Saleh, AUB GIH, Lebanon Dr Iyad Sultan, Paediatric Oncologist and Chief Health Informatics Officer, King Hussein Cancer Center, Jordan Dr Novera Ansari, Technical Officer, Digital Health Innovation, WHO EMRO Mohammed Al Marri, Executive Director, GAFAI
15:00 – 15:20	Knowledge Transfer · Special Lecture **Health AI Governance in Hospital Settings**	Dr Ahmed Abu Salah, Founding Director, AI Hub
15:20 – 15:30	Knowledge Transfer · Special Lecture **When Digital Twin Meets Agentic AI: The Future of AI-Powered Computational Biology**	Dr Koray Atalag, Clinical Program Board Member, openEHR, New Zealand
15:30 – 15:45	*Coffee & Networking Break*	
AMBIENT AI INNOVATION CONTEST · 15:45 – 17:00		
15:45 – 15:55	Contest Briefing **Testing Responsible Ambient AI Solutions for Clinical Documentation and Bedside Workflow**	

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Time	Session	Speakers
15:55 – 16:35	**Finalist Pitches** **3 Teams × 3 Pitches (2 use cases per pitch)** › *Scribing consultations (multi-language / dialects) testing* › *Suggested documentation (coding) & summarisation*	Finalist teams **Jury:** Dr Melanie Tan, Consultant Anaesthetist & Perioperative Physician, University College London Hospitals NHS Trust; Director of Medical Informatics, Cleveland Clinic London Dr Ahmad Awada, Innovations and Digital Health Director, Mediclinic Middle East Dr Iyad Sultan, Paediatric Oncologist and Chief Health Informatics Officer, King Hussein Cancer Center
16:35 – 16:50	**Judging** **Jury Deliberation and Audience Voting**	Jury (Dr Melanie Tan, Dr Ahmad Awada, Dr Iyad Sultan)
16:50 – 17:00	**Award** **Winners Announcement**	

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Workshop: Competency-based Framework for Digital Health Careers

The Future of the Digital Health Workforce in the Age of AI

5 November 2026 · 08:00 AM – 4:10 PM

Speaker status: Confirmed | Awaiting confirmation or details | Not attending in person | No highlight: not on speaker tracker | Different from last version

Time	Session	Speakers
MORNING SESSION · 08:00 – 12:30		
08:00 – 08:45	Registration **Registration, Arrival Coffee and Networking**	Survey participation forms collected at the desk
08:45 – 09:00	Welcome **Welcome and Setting the Scene**	Derrick Muneene, Chair, WHO Prof Amr Jamal, Co-Chair, ZIMAM Prof Mowafa Househ, Co-Chair, HBKU
09:00 – 09:15	**The Landscape of UAE Healthcare Workforce Development: The Need for Clinical Informatics Fellowships**	Dr Mohammed Al-Houqani, Secretary General, National Institute for Health Specialties, UAE
09:15 – 09:35	Opening Keynote **Celebrating the WHO Competency-based Framework for Digital Health** *› Keynote with 10 minutes of questions*	Derrick Muneene, WHO
09:35 – 09:50	Launch **The ZIMAM × WHO EMRO Digital Health Workforce Survey** *› Joint launch, instrument walkthrough and call for participation*	Dr Novera Ansari, Consultant, WHO EMRO, Egypt Prof Amr Jamal, Co-Chair, Lead, ZIMAM, UAE WHO EMRO leadership
09:50 – 10:10	International Session (online) **Incorporating AI in Digital Health Competency-based Frameworks**	Australasian Institute of Digital Health (AIDH), Australia Online · 16:50 – 17:10 Sydney time

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Time	Session	Speakers
10:10 – 10:45	Executive Panel **Leveraging Multilateral Platforms for Preparing an AI-fluent Healthcare Workforce**	**Moderator:** Dr Dari Al-Huwail **Panelists:** Brian Francesca, Executive Council Member, Arab Hospitals Federation, UAE Dr Shadi Saleh, Founding Director, AUB Institute of Global Health, Lebanon Prof Umit Cali, Professor & Founding Director of ARC, AUS, UAE
10:45 – 11:05	Fireside Chat **The Future of Digital Healthcare Workforce in the Intelligent Hospitals of Tomorrow**	Sandeep Kumar, CIO, King's College Hospital, UAE Jamal Masalmeh, IT Expert-Program Manager, EHS, UAE Raed Rafeh, Director of Solutions and Applications Delivery, Dubai Health, UAE
11:05 – 11:20	*Coffee Break and Networking*	
11:20 – 11:55	Keynote (10 min) + Fireside Chat **Women Leadership in Digital Health: A Digital Health Fellowship Program**	Adj Prof Anita Ghose, Program Lead, AIDH, Australia Dr Tamara Sunbul, Partnership Lead & Board Member, ZIMAM, KSA Reenita Das, Co-Founder & CTO, NXT Horizon, UAE
11:55 – 12:10	Keynote **Bridging the Talent Gap in AI Governance**	Brian Francesca, Executive Council Member, Arab Hospitals Federation, UAE
12:10 – 12:30	Fireside Chat **Interoperability Competencies in the Age of AI**	Dr Koray Atalag, Clinical Program, Board Member, openEHR, New Zealand Ilya Beda, Interoperability Expert, Australia
12:30 – 13:30	*Lunch Break and Dhuhr Prayers*	
AFTERNOON SESSION · 13:30 – 16:10		
13:30 – 14:15	Researcher Presentation Panel **Evidence on AI and the Digital Health Workforce** *› 10 minutes per presenter*	**Moderator:** Prof Mowafa Househ, HBKU, Qatar **Presenters:** Hana Abu Sharib, SSMC, UAE Dr Rawad Hodeify, RAK Medical Science University, UAE Dr Mohammed El-Hadidi, Birmingham University, UAE MBZUAI speaker (TBC)

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Time	Session	Speakers
14:15 – 14:35	Regional Academic Session (online) **The Saudi Competency-based Framework, King Saud University**	Dr Raniya AlDhakeel, King Saud University team, KSA Online · 13:15 – 13:35 Riyadh time
14:35 – 14:50	*Coffee Break*	
14:50 – 15:25	Academic Panel **Bridging the Gap between University Outcomes and Market Requirements in Digital Health Transformation**	**Moderator:** Prof Amr Jamal, Co-founder & Board Member, ZIMAM, KSA **Panelists:** Dr Ikram Rehman, Associate Professor, Middlesex University, UAE Jamal Masalmeh, IT Expert-Program Manager, EHS, UAE Raed Rafeh, Director of Solutions and Applications Delivery, Dubai Health, UAE
15:25 – 15:45	Keynote **The Road to MEDINFO 2027: Reflecting Health/Medical Informatics in MENA to the World**	Prof Mowafa Househ, HBKU, Qatar
15:45 – 16:00	Keynote (online) **Highlights on the WHO Competency-based Framework**	Dr Taghreed Justinia, Expert Panel Member, Global Digital Health & AI Competency Framework, WHO, KSA
16:00 – 16:10	Closing **Closing Remarks and Recommendations** *› Recommendations read back with named owners*	All three Chairs